response, the Natal Indian Congress was founded in 1894, with Gandhi as its first secretary. The political movement in South Africa shaped Gandhi's thinking and methods of resistance, claimed successes such as ending indentured emigration to Natal in 1911 and abolishing a poll tax through the Indian Relief Act of 1914. The next year, Gandhi returned to India to take part in the Indian freedom movement.

The Indians who stayed behind in South Africa got caught in the tension between the Africans and the Whites and suffered from strong segregation polices enforced by the state. They coalesced around their Indian identity in Natal and a few other pockets of South Africa. By 1950, nearly fifty Indian organizations served various requirements of the community from welfare to entertainment. The political movement continued to have links with India until 1947, but severed ties after India attained independence. The Department of Indian Affairs was set up in 1961, which expanded educational opportunities and contributed to considerable economic mobility of the Indians as compared to the Africans. The children of the ex-indentured workers received better education, and in contrast with the Malaya world, average skill levels of the Indian community went up. More Indian women joined the workforce and a class of Indian industrialists also emerged. But all along, the apartheid regime that lasted till 1994 exacerbated racial tensions with conflicting support from the Indian side towards the Africans and ruling elites. In the post-apartheid era, the tensions have only partially subsided as the million-strong Indian-origin community that makes up 2 per cent of the South African population and 10 per cent of KwaZulu-Natal's population is now seen as an upwardly mobile class.

Outside East Africa and South Africa, Indians also made inroads into central and West Africa in the 20th century. The Chanrai Group, for instance, started as textile traders in Sindh and expanded through Malta in the 1870s to Nigeria in 1900. Since then, it has expanded all over the world. The Goan diaspora in Mozambique and Portuguese Africa has partially relocated to Portugal, and a small Indian trading diaspora also exists in Madagascar. Several countries now host tens of thousands of recent Indian